SIGHT AFRICA · STRATEGIC OPERATING SYSTEM

AFRICA FINTECH JOURNAL

Independent media + research on fintech, Bitcoin, AI, startups and cyber

Execution starts 1 January 2027 · 2026 is a preparation year outside the agenda · All amounts in FBU

1. What we expect from this product

AFJ is expected to own the narrative and the data of the African digital economy. It buys attention and credibility that no advertising budget could buy, and monetises them through research, events and institutional subscriptions.

- Become the reference publication of francophone African fintech.
- Build proprietary datasets (operators, volumes, regulation) nobody else has.
- Convert audience into institutional research revenue at high margin.
- 1M+ professional audience and 90 M FBU revenue by 2036.

2. Economic model

Revenue line	Mechanism	Target margin
Sponsorship	Newsletter and report sponsors	65%
Premium research	Annual institutional subscription	80%
Events & summit	Tickets + partner packages	45%
Research-as-a-service	Custom studies for banks, DFIs, regulators	60%
Indices & benchmarks	Licensed data products	85%

3. Investment required

Phase	Window	Capital needed	Main use
Preparation	2026	3 M FBU	Editorial charter, brand, first datasets
Launch	2027	15 M FBU	2 journalists, CMS, distribution
Scale	2028–2030	60 M FBU	Research desk, annual summit
Institution	2031–2036	200 M FBU	Data platform, regional bureaus

4. Feasibility assessment

Dimension	Assessment	Condition to satisfy
Technical	Very high	Headless CMS + email deliverability

Regulatory	High	Press registration, right-of-reply discipline
Operational	Medium	Sustained editorial cadence without quality loss
Financial	Medium	Sponsorship concentration must stay < 25% per client
Talent	Medium	Editor-in-chief with regional credibility

5. Technology & operating stack

- Headless CMS + CDN, newsletter infrastructure with strong deliverability.
- Structured research database (operators, funding, regulation, volumes).
- AI editorial copilots for translation and data extraction — never for bylines.
- Paywall and entitlements settled through BitLibera.

6. Key performance indicators

Metric	2027	2031	2036
Subscribers	25 000	250 000	1 000 000
Paying institutions	5	60	300
Revenue	3 M FBU	30 M FBU	90 M FBU
Editorial output / month	12 pieces	40 pieces	80 pieces

7. Risks & mitigations

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
Independence vs. monetisation	Critical	Published editorial charter, separate commercial team
AI-generated content commoditisation	High	Proprietary data + on-the-ground reporting
Ad revenue volatility	Medium	Shift mix toward subscriptions and research
Legal exposure	Medium	Pre-publication legal review on sensitive pieces

8. Ten-year trajectory

TODAY

Dimension	Detail
Users	Pre-launch / early readership
Revenue	0

Features	Editorial pipeline · Newsletter
Market position	Niche regional fintech voice
Risks	Editorial quality
Advantage	First-mover, founder credibility
Stack	Ghost/Notion + CDN
Team	3

1 YEAR

Dimension	Detail
Users	25k subscribers
Revenue	3M FBU (sponsorship + events)
Features	Weekly newsletter · Quarterly reports
Market position	Reference fintech publication in francophone Africa
Risks	Ad revenue volatility
Advantage	Trusted independent voice
Stack	Headless CMS
Team	8

5 YEARS

Dimension	Detail
Users	250k subscribers, 1M readers
Revenue	30M FBU (research + events + sponsorship)
Features	Premium research · Industry awards · Annual summit
Market position	African fintech category-defining media
Risks	Independence vs. monetization
Advantage	Owned audience + data
Stack	Custom publishing platform
Team	45

10 YEARS

Dimension	Detail
Users	1M+ professional audience
Revenue	90M FBU

Features	Research-as-a-service · Indices & benchmarks
Market position	Standard reference for African digital economy
Risks	Disruption from AI-generated content
Advantage	Proprietary data + relationships
Stack	Data products + AI publishing
Team	180

MATURE

Dimension	Detail
Users	Institutional clients (banks, DFIs, regulators)
Revenue	High-margin recurring
Features	Africa Fintech Index · Policy advisory
Market position	Equivalent of FT/Stratechery for African digital economy
Risks	Trust capital
Advantage	Editorial independence + data moat
Stack	Internal AI editorial copilots
Team	Standalone media subsidiary